SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 32

Users & Organization-Level Security

Complete Guide — User Object, Global Uniqueness, Licenses, Freeze vs. Deactivate & Troubleshooting

- 👤 User Object & Mandatory Fields
- 🌐 Username Global Uniqueness
- 🪪 User License vs. Profile vs. Role
- 🧊 Freeze vs. Deactivate vs. Delete
- 🔍 Login History & Login As Troubleshooting
- 🔑 Security Token & Password Resets

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL	LAYER 1
32 of Series	~26 Minutes	Intermediate	Org Security

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Course Context

⏱ 0:00 – 1:00

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In Episode 31, we explored the complete 4-tier Salesforce Security Model (*Organization, Object, Field, and Record level*).

Today, we begin our deep dive into the very first gate: **Organization-Level Security & Users**. Every security evaluation begins with the User identity: *Can this person authenticate? Is their user active? What license dictates their technical limits? What regional settings govern their dates and times?*

As a Salesforce Administrator, user lifecycle management—creating, licensing, freezing, deactivating, and troubleshooting user logins—is an everyday core responsibility!

SECTION 2 — CORE ARCHITECTURE

What is a User & The User Object

⏱ 1:00 – 3:30

📌 OFFICIAL DEFINITION

A Salesforce User represents an individual or system identity that has access to a Salesforce org. Under the hood, **User is a standard Salesforce object** just like Account or Contact, meaning every user in your company is a record in the `User` database table!

Username

Globally unique login ID across all Salesforce orgs.

Email

Receives password resets and system notifications.

User License

Baseline license determining available features.

Profile

Controls baseline object CRED and field permissions.

Role

Hierarchy position governing record sharing.

Active

Checkbox enabling or disabling org access.

SECTION 3 — CRITICAL CONCEPT

Username vs. Email (Global Uniqueness)

⏱ 3:30 – 5:30

⚠️ **GLOBAL UNIQUENESS RULE**

A Salesforce **Username must be globally unique across ALL Salesforce organizations in the world** (including all Sandboxes, Production orgs, and Developer Editions)!

Criterion	🆔 Username	📧 Email Address
Primary Function	Login identification & authentication credentials	Communications, password resets & system alerts
Uniqueness Scope	**Globally Unique** across all Salesforce orgs globally	Can be reused across multiple users and orgs
Format Requirement	Must be in email format (e.g., `name@domain.com`)	Standard valid corporate/personal email
Must be a Real Inbox?	**NO.** Does not need to receive real email.	**YES.** User must access it to reset passwords.

SECTION 4 — CORE DISTINCTION

⚖️ User License vs. Profile vs. Role

⏱ 5:30 – 8:30

Concept	Core Question Answered	Primary Impact
🪪 **User License**	*"What broad type of Salesforce user are you?"*	Unlocks technical features, storage, and standard objects (e.g., Salesforce License vs. Platform License)
👮 **Profile**	*"What are you allowed to DO?"*	Base permissions: Object permissions (CRED), Field-Level Security (FLS), System permissions, App/Tab access
👔 **Role**	*"Which RECORDS can you access?"*	Positions the user in the reporting hierarchy; grants access to subordinate records via the sharing model

🧠 MEMORY RULE

License ➔ What features are available?
Profile ➔ What permissions do you have?
Role ➔ Which records can you see in the hierarchy?

SECTION 5

🌍 Time Zone, Locale, Language & Federation ID

⏱ 8:30 – 11:30

- **Time Zone:** Sets the user's primary working time zone. When an Opportunity closes at 5:00 PM IST, an admin in California sees it as 3:30 AM PST!
- **Locale:** Dictates regional formatting for dates, date/time, numbers, currencies, and calendar displays (e.g., `MM/DD/YYYY` in US vs. `DD/MM/YYYY` in India/UK).
- **Language:** Determines the user interface language for standard and custom translated labels.
- **Federation ID:** The unique identity string linking the Salesforce user to an external Identity Provider (IdP) for **Single Sign-On (SSO)**.

SECTIONS 6 & 7 — USER LIFECYCLE

Active vs. Freeze vs. Deactivate vs. Delete

⏱ 11:30 – 15:00

❌ **WHY CAN'T WE DELETE A USER IN SALESFORCE?**

Salesforce **does not permit deleting internal users**. Users are permanently tied to historical activities, created records, audits, approval histories, and ownership. Deleting a user would break database relational integrity. We **deactivate** users instead!

State	Active Checkbox	Can User Log In?	Frees Up User License?	When to Use?
🟢 **Active**	Checked (Yes)	✅ Yes	❌ Consumes 1 license	Normal day-to-day working state
🧊 **Frozen**	Checked (Yes)	❌ **No (Blocked)**	❌ **Does NOT free license**	Immediate emergency lock; pending investigation; user in mid-transfer
❌ **Deactivated**	Unchecked (No)	❌ **No (Disabled)**	✅ **FREES UP LICENSE**	Employee left company; permanent departure

SECTION 8 — ADMIN TOOLING

Login History & "Login As"

⏱ 15:00 – 17:30

1. Login History (Setup ➔ Login History)

When a user complains *"Salesforce won't let me log in"*, checking **Login History** is your very first step. It displays up to **20,000 login attempts** over the past 6 months, detailing:

- **Status:** *Success* vs. *Invalid Password* vs. *Restricted IP* vs. *Login Hours*
- **Source IP & Location:** Detects unusual geographic login attempts
- **Login Type:** Application, Data Loader, API, OAuth, SSO

2. "Login As" (Impersonation)

Instead of asking for screenshots or passwords, authorized administrators can click **Login** directly on a user's record to experience Salesforce through their exact permissions, apps, tabs, and page layouts!

SECTION 9

🔑 Password Reset & The Salesforce Security Token

⏱ 17:30 – 19:30

📌 WHAT IS A SECURITY TOKEN?

A **Salesforce Security Token** is a case-sensitive alphanumeric key used in combination with your password (`Password + SecurityToken`) when authenticating from desktop tools (Data Loader, VS Code) or external APIs outside your company's trusted IP ranges.

💡 PASSWORD RESET & TOKEN INVALIDATION

When an Administrator clicks **Reset Password** on a user record, Salesforce automatically **resets that user's Security Token as well** and dispatches the new token via email!

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 32

01

User is a standard object; managing users in Setup is equivalent to creating records in the `User` table.

02

Usernames must be globally unique across all Salesforce orgs in the world, while emails can be shared.

03

License dictates available features; **Profile** governs permissions; **Role** controls record hierarchy access.

04

Users **CANNOT be deleted**; they must be deactivated to preserve historical record ownership and audits.

05

Freeze blocks login access immediately while keeping the user active (does NOT release license); **Deactivate** releases the license.

06

Troubleshoot with **Login History** (shows failed attempts) and **Login As** (reproduces the user's exact UI).

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 33

Login Security, Password Policies & MFA

Explore Login Hours, IP Range restrictions, password expiration policies, and Multi-Factor Authentication!

These notes are an official companion to the YouTube video. Practice hands-on in your Salesforce Developer Org!